

FOR CURRENT STUDENTS

Graduate School

The Graduate School Admission Process

Applying to graduate school can be a lengthy and involved process, so we recommend that students begin the process as soon as they know they are interested. Applications for PhD programs are typically due in December or January. Some graduate programs have two separate deadlines (one for admissions and one for financial aid) and applicants are encouraged to submit everything before the earlier deadline.

Because admission to graduate programs is extremely competitive, we suggest that students send applications to at least five schools. We encourage students to use the rankings below to choose the schools to which they will apply. Students should use the internet to begin learning about graduate schools’ strengths and specialties and to request paper applications or access to on-line applications.

Once the student has chosen the schools to which they will apply, they should then begin the process of putting together their application. Typically, graduate school applications require the following

- Transcripts
- GRE scores
- Letters of recommendation (usually three)
- Personal statement or Statement of purpose
- Application fees
- Writing sample
- Financial aid application

Some applicants also choose to send additional materials, such as a CV (curriculum vita). While many aspects of the graduate school application are straightforward, others require careful thought. Students are encouraged to discuss their interest in graduate school and their applications with professors in the department.

Rankings of Top Graduate Programs in Anthropology and Sociology

ANTHROPOLOGY

Anthropology research-doctoral programs were evaluated by the National Research Council in 1993. The methodology is described in “Rankings of Research-Doctorate Programs in 41 Disciplines at 274 Institutions,” Chronicle of Higher Education 42: A21-A30, September 25, 1995. The ranking is reprinted in Lynn C. Hattendorf Westney (Ed.), Educational Rankings Annual: 2003, Detroit: Thomas Gale, 2003.

04. Harvard University
05. University of Arizona
06. University of Pennsylvania
07. Stanford University
08. Yale University— . UCLA— . University of California - San Diego
09. University of Florida
10. University of Texas - Austin
11. New York University
12. University of Illinois - Champaign-Urbana
13. University of California - Davis

SOCIOLOGY

For rankings of the top 100 Graduate Programs in Sociology from *US News and World Report* (the most recent rankings are from 2024), click [here](#) .